

Eva Zlimen

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PhD Student, UCLA

evazlimen.github.io

RESEARCH INTERESTS	Orbital dynamics, planetary formation, interior-atmosphere interactions, solar system evolution, space sustainability		
EDUCATION	The University of California, Los Angeles , Los Angeles, CA		
	PhD, Planetary Science		Expected, 2029
	Advised by Professor Hilke Schlichting		
	Masters of Science, Planetary Science		June 2026
	The University of California, Santa Cruz , Santa Cruz, CA		
	Bachelor of Science, Physics (Astrophysics)		June 2024
	Thesis: <i>Extensive Ice Pollution of Uranus and Neptune's Atmospheres by Upsweep of Material During the Nice Model Migration</i>		
	Advised by Professor Ruth Murray-Clay and Dr. Elizabeth Bailey		
	Received the Steck award for finest senior thesis		
	Earth and Planetary Science minor		
SELECTED ACADEMIC AWARDS AND HONORS	• Kenneth and Ann Thimann Scholarship , UC Santa Cruz		May 2024
	• Steck Family Thesis Award UC Santa Cruz		May 2024
	• Chancellor's Thesis Award , UC Santa Cruz		May 2024
	• Dean's Thesis Award , UC Santa Cruz		May 2024
PUBLICATIONS	1. Zlimen, E. , Bailey, E., Murray-Clay, R. (2024). Extensive Ice Pollution of Uranus and Neptune's Atmospheres by Upsweep of Material During the Nice Model Migration. <i>AJ</i> .		
GRANTS	• NSF Graduate Research Fellowship		2024-Present
	• Undergraduate Research in Science and Technology , UC Santa Cruz		2023
INTERNSHIPS	Dynamical histories of Uranus and Neptune May 2022 - May 2024		
	<i>University of California, Santa Cruz</i> , Santa Cruz, CA		
	Undergraduate Research Assistant under Professor Ruth Murray-Clay		
	• Write, maintain, and debug direct orbital n-body simulations in C and python.		
	• Perform data analysis and visualization.		
	• Present results to academics and the local community in jargon-free language.		
	CHOLLA May 2023 - July 2024		
	<i>University of California, Santa Cruz</i> , Santa Cruz, CA		
	Undergraduate Research Assistant under Professor Brant Robertson		
	• Debug, document, and upgrade a GPU-based hydro code.		
	• Increase user-friendly features to optimize usability of the code.		
	• Create documentation for the code available as part of the CHOLLA wiki on GitHub.		

SUMMER SCHOOLS AND WORKSHOPS

AstroTech

July 2023

- Five day summer school for students and early-career individuals from a broad range of backgrounds gain skills, knowledge, and mindset to advance in the field of instrumentation.
- Topics covered: hands-on experience in an optics lab building a spectrograph, team building and inclusive teamwork, spectrograph testing, professional skills, networking.

CUWiP

January 2022, 2023

- Conferences for Undergraduate Women in Physics. Virtual (2022) and in person at UC Santa Cruz (2023).
- Topics covered: career paths, imposter syndrome, public policy, networking, communication and negotiation.

PhyComm

May 2021

- Science communication conference for physics and astronomy students. Virtual conference at UC Santa Cruz.
- Topics covered: using effective science communication in our day-to-day, incorporating SciComm into performance media, sharing about how to improve our scientific writing, breaking down science concepts with no jargon.

OUTREACH

UCLA Exploring Your Universe

May 2025 - Present

Speaker Chair

- Organize speaker lineup for the largest science fair in LA County.
- Recruit, schedule, advertise, and prepare 18+ speakers for a public-facing event.
- Facilitate moderation of talks and oversee volunteers on the day of event, where over 10,000 visitors attend.

EPSS Family Mentorship Program

March 2025 - Present

President, Nov 2025-Present

Academic Events Chair, March 2025-Nov 2026

- Run the UCLA Earth, Planetary, and Space Sciences mentorship program.
- Pair undergraduate and graduates into mentorship “families” and coordinate community building and academic events, such as game nights and career panels.
- Run the No-Jargon talk series, where students can practice science communication with 10 minute plain-language talks.

Physics Mentoring Program

Fall 2022 - Spring 2024

UC Santa Cruz

Mentor

- Mentor to fellow undergraduate student.
- Advising on academic planning, time management, self-advocacy, and navigating the UCSC physics program.
- Providing support for the transition to college.

Women in Physics and Astrophysics

Fall 2021 - June 2022

UC Santa Cruz

Outreach Committee

- Coordinated STEM tutoring for local high school students.
- Organized campus visit with workshops and lab tour of UCSC for local high school.

SKILLS

Software and Languages

- Python, C, C++, L^AT_EX, HTML, REBOUND, CHOLLA, cluster computing

Miscellaneous

- Academic research, data analysis, problem solving, effective communication, inclusive teamwork

POSTERS

1. **Zlimen, E.**, Schlichting, H., Rogers, J. G. *Revisiting Atmospheric Mass Loss due to Giant Impacts for Sub-Neptunes with Miscible Interiors*, Exoplanets 6, Porto June 2026.
2. **Zlimen, E.**, Schlichting, H. *Revisiting Atmospheric Mass Loss due to Giant Impacts Among Sub-Neptunes*, ExSoCal, Los Angeles December 2025.
3. **Zlimen, E.**, Schlichting, H. *Revisiting Atmospheric Mass Loss due to Giant Impacts Among Sub-Neptunes*, Origins of Solar Systems Gordon Research Conference, South Hadley June 2025.
4. **Zlimen, E.**, Bailey, E., Murray-Clay, R. *Extensive Ice Pollution of Uranus and Neptune's Atmospheres by Upsweep of Material During the Nice Model Migration*, American Astronomical Society 243, New Orleans Jan 10 2024.

TALKS

- Eva Zlimen, *Formation of Super-Earths and Sub-Neptunes with Giant Impacts*, UCLA Geophysics Seminar, May 20, 2026.
- Eva Zlimen, *Icy pollution of Uranus and Neptune's atmospheres: Influences on thermal evolution and composition*, UCLA Planetary Science Seminar, January 16, 2025.
- Eva Zlimen, *Atmospheric Ice Pollution of Uranus and Neptune*, UCSC Science Research Awards Celebration, April 2024.
- Eva Zlimen, *The Story of a Planet Named Neptune...*, UCSC No Jargon Talks, February 2023.

ACADEMIC ASSOCIATIONS

- American Astronomical Society
- American Physical Society